

Bridge Day 8 INSTRUCTOR KEY

Expected-vs-Actual Debugging and Test Design

Learning sequence: Predict - Trace - Explain - Test - Interpret

Instructor key with answers in student response locations

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Concrete engineering situation

The sensor-kit checkout decision logic is now being tested. Some branch outcomes look safe for one kit but fail for another. Today the focus is debugging: separate the observed behavior from the expected behavior, identify a likely cause, choose a minimal fix, and keep a test that would catch the bug again.

Engineering task	Use a repair log to decide whether the checkout decision logic is trustworthy before the lab uses it.
Computational move	Compare expected and actual behavior, connect the mismatch to a code cause, and design tests that cover important branch outcomes.
Python focus	expected branch outcome, actual branch outcome, condition order, Boolean release condition, minimal fix, boundary and regression tests.
Evidence to keep	symptom, expected branch outcome, actual branch outcome, likely cause, minimal repair, test case, and support category.

Day 8 working rules

1. A symptom says what went wrong.
2. Expected behavior says what should have happened.
3. Actual behavior says what the code did.
4. A likely cause points to a condition or order problem.
5. A regression test keeps a known bug from quietly returning.

1. Separate symptom, cause, and repair

recognize

debug

The checkout desk finds that some kits are assigned incorrectly. A good debug note separates what happened, what should have happened, and what line likely caused it.

```
charge_percent = 82
calibration_label = "expired"
borrower_initials = "KM"

if charge_percent >= 80:
    action = "release kit"
elif calibration_label != "current":
    action = "calibration bench"
elif borrower_initials == "":
    action = "borrower log needed"
else:
    action = "hold for review"
```

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence
1	What branch outcome will the current code assign?	Key: release kit.
1	What branch outcome should the kit receive if calibration is expired?	Key: calibration bench.
1	Which line lets the kit release too early?	Key: The first condition, if <code>charge_percent >= 80:</code> , lets any high-charge kit release before checking calibration.
1	Is the first problem a syntax error or a logic error?	Key: Logic error. The code runs, but the branch outcome does not match the checkout policy.

2. Build an expected-vs-actual table**trace****debug**

Use the same code. Complete the table and name the likely cause.

Pts.	Case	Expected branch outcome	Actual branch outcome	Likely cause
2	charge 82, expired calibration	calibration bench	Key: see reason	Key: Actual branch outcome: <code>release kit</code> . Likely cause: the first high-charge condition releases the kit before the calibration check.
2	charge 76, current calibration	charge station	Key: see reason	Key: Actual branch outcome: <code>hold for review</code> . Likely cause: the code has no low-charge branch such as <code>elif charge_percent < 80</code> .
2	charge 90, current calibration, blank initials	borrower log needed	Key: see reason	Key: Actual branch outcome: <code>release kit</code> . Likely cause: the first condition checks charge only and reaches release before checking borrower initials.
2	Explain which case best exposes the bug.	Key: The charge 82 with expired calibration case is clearest: actual is <code>release kit</code> , but expected is <code>calibration bench</code> , showing the release condition is too broad.		

3. Design tests before trusting a repair**test****explain**

A repair is not trustworthy just because it works for one case. Pick cases that cover the branch outcomes.

Pts.	Prompt	My test evidence
2	Give a test case that should produce "charge station".	Key: <code>charge_percent = 76, calibration_label = "current", and initials present</code> should produce <code>charge station</code> .
2	Give a test case that should produce "calibration bench".	Key: <code>charge_percent = 82, calibration_label = "expired", and initials present</code> should produce <code>calibration bench</code> .
2	Give a test case that should produce "borrower log needed".	Key: <code>charge_percent = 82, calibration_label = "current", and borrower_initials = ""</code> should produce <code>borrower log needed</code> .
2	Give a test case that should produce "release kit".	Key: <code>charge_percent = 82, calibration_label = "current", and initials present</code> should produce <code>release kit</code> .

Regression-test idea

A regression test is a small case you keep because it catches a bug that already happened once. If the bug comes back, that test should fail again.

4. Choose a minimal fix

One safe repair is to require all release evidence before assigning "release kit". Complete the condition.

```
if charge_percent >= 80 and calibration_label == "current" and borrower_initials != "":
    action = "release kit"
elif charge_percent < 80:
    action = "charge station"
elif calibration_label != "current":
    action = "calibration bench"
elif borrower_initials == "":
    action = "borrower log needed"
else:
    action = "hold for review"
```

Pts.	Prompt	My response
2	Why does the release condition need three evidence checks?	Key: Release is safe only when charge is high enough, calibration is <code>current</code> , and borrower initials are present; one passing check is not enough.
2	Which branch outcome will the expired-calibration case now receive?	Key: <code>calibration bench</code> .
2	What risk remains if damage evidence is added later but not checked first?	Key: A damaged but otherwise ready kit could still be released before the damage rule runs; damage should be checked before release.
2	Name one test you would rerun after this repair.	Key: Rerun the expired-calibration regression case: <code>charge_percent = 82</code> , <code>calibration_label = "expired"</code> , initials present should produce <code>calibration bench</code> .

5. Write a repair log[debug](#)[test](#)[explain](#)

Log field	My repair evidence
Symptom	Key: Expired-calibration kits can be assigned to release kit when charge is high enough.
Expected behavior	Key: A kit with expired calibration should produce calibration bench , not release.
Likely cause	Key: The first condition checks charge only, so it is too broad and skips later calibration/initials evidence.
Minimal fix	Key: Require all release evidence in the release condition: charge at least 80, calibration current , and borrower initials present .
Regression test	Key: Keep the expired-calibration case: charge 82, calibration expired , initials present should produce calibration bench .

6. Transfer and support plan**transfer****explain**

Pts.	Debugging note
4	Explain why expected-vs-actual evidence is stronger than saying "the code is wrong." Use one branch outcome from the sensor-kit checkout example. Key: Expected-vs-actual evidence states both the policy and the observed branch outcome. For an expired-calibration kit, expected is calibration bench but actual was release kit, pointing to the too-broad release condition.
2	Circle the support plan you would use next: symptom / expected branch outcome / actual branch outcome / cause / test case / minimal fix. Name one next action: _____

Bridge to Exam 1 and Day 10

Day 9 is Exam 1. Use expected-vs-actual evidence, minimal repair, boundary tests, and support-plan notes as Exam 1 preparation. Day 10 returns to branch maps and test evidence after the exam and bridges into repeated cases and loops.

7. Lab bridge: use visible checks as debugging evidence

VIP 18.8

Instructor Key

Scope boundary: repair order only

The interface is already correct. The bug is that the broad `<= 16` rule comes before the specific `<= 8` rule. Students should use expected-versus-actual evidence and make one minimal ordering repair. The page is unscored.

```
def badge_sheet_plan(group_count, badges_per_group):
    total_badges = group_count * badges_per_group
    if total_badges <= 16:
        return "two sheets"
    elif total_badges <= 8:
        return "one sheet"
    else:
        return "print batch"
```

Total	Expected	Actual from wrong order	Evidence / likely cause
8	one sheet	Key: two sheets	Key: The first <code><= 16</code> rule is already true, so the later <code><= 8</code> rule is skipped.
9	two sheets	Key: two sheets	Key: This case passes despite the bug; one passing check does not prove the order is correct.
17	print batch	Key: print batch	Key: Both comparisons are false, so <code>else</code> runs.
Minimal repair		Key: Check <code>total_badges <= 8</code> first; then check <code>total_badges <= 16</code> ; keep <code>else</code> last.	
Regression tests to keep		Key: Keep 8, 9, 16, and 17 so both sides of both boundaries remain visible.	

Visible-check recovery loop

Have students rerun the editable file cell and then the matching check cell. Do not accept changes to the setup or check harness as a fix.

Bridge Day 8 INSTRUCTOR KEY

VIP Evidence Handoff

Learning sequence: Predict - Trace - Explain - Test - Interpret

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Why engineers use this page

Use expected-versus-actual evidence on the current sample and transfer cells instead of debugging an obsolete wrapper.

Decision boundary: Code is useful only when its stored state, visible result, assumptions, units, limits, and tests support a defensible engineering interpretation.

Construct readiness before independent work

New authoring tools: comparison expression, boolean operator, if elif else, abs call, counter update

Carried authoring tools: assignment, print call, numeric literal, arithmetic expression, input call, int conversion, float conversion, f string

Supplied-code exposure only: for loop, list traversal

An exposure-only construct may be traced in complete supplied code, but the independent task will not require students to invent it before its authoring day.

Notebook cells and task constructs

Activity	Work	Stable cells	Required authoring constructs
18.13	Compare With Tolerance	18-13-work / 18-13-transfer / 18-13-cold	comparison expression, f string, float conversion, input call
18.14	Count High Readings	18-14-work / 18-14-transfer / 18-14-cold	arithmetic expression, comparison expression, counter update, f string, if elif else
18.15	Lamination Fee	18-15-work / 18-15-transfer / 18-15-cold	comparison expression, f string, if elif else, input call, int conversion
18.16	Temperature Status	18-16-work / 18-16-transfer / 18-16-cold	comparison expression, f string, float conversion, if elif else, input call
18.17	Pickup Window	18-17-work / 18-17-transfer / 18-17-cold	boolean operator, comparison expression, f string, if elif else, input call, int conversion

Readiness evidence

1. Choose one sample or transfer case and record expected result, actual result, likely cause, and the smallest justified repair.

Model response: The response must use a real Lab Day 4 cell and distinguish expected result, actual result, cause, and minimal repair; it must not propose rewriting the notebook interface.

2. Name one boundary pair that differs by only one unit or one small measurement change.

Model response: Accept a valid adjacent boundary pair tied to the chosen activity, such as 8/9 or 16/17 for an ordered category, or values immediately around a stated tolerance or time boundary.

Timing and help trigger

Record a first prediction before running. If you still lack an executable plan after about 8 focused minutes, use the linked ThinkCSPy refresher or the supplied model. If two attempts fail for the same named requirement, write the exact mismatch and ask a peer mentor or instructor a targeted question. Timing is diagnostic evidence, not a speed grade. **Start or elapsed minutes:** _____

My help trigger:

Engineering Evidence Record

Complete one record from a model, transfer, or Independent Program Studio build. Generic statements are not sufficient; use actual values, a real revision, and one concrete next test.

Evidence field	Record
Prediction	A specific expected state or output before execution.
Observed Result	The actual state or output, including a value or exact text.
Revision Reason	The defect or mismatch and the change that addresses it.
Engineering Meaning	How the evidence changes or supports the engineering decision.
Units Or Not Applicable	The physical unit, or the evidence type when no unit applies.
Assumption	One condition accepted as true for this model or rule.
Model Limit	One situation the result does not justify or predict.
Next Test	A concrete boundary, invalid, or alternate case with an expected result.
Help Trigger	The exact unresolved point that would trigger a targeted question.
Minutes Used	Approximate minutes from first prediction through revision.

Notebook and submission procedure

1. Attempt, predict, run, inspect, and revise before opening a reveal.
2. Complete the end-of-notebook Independent Program Studio without a reveal or copied solution. Only those visibly labeled Studio cells are scored for independent mastery.
3. Save or download the completed notebook as one `.ipynb` file.
4. Upload that one notebook to the matching Gradescope assignment. Do not export a `.py` file or create a ZIP.